

Tips for Publishing Papers in Refereed Journals

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How to Review a Journal Article

- What is the purpose of this article?
- Why is it important to investigate or examine the subject of the article?
- How are the authors carrying out the task? Are their methods and comments appropriate and adequate to the task?
- What do they claim to have found out? Are the findings clearly stated?
- How does this advance knowledge in the field?

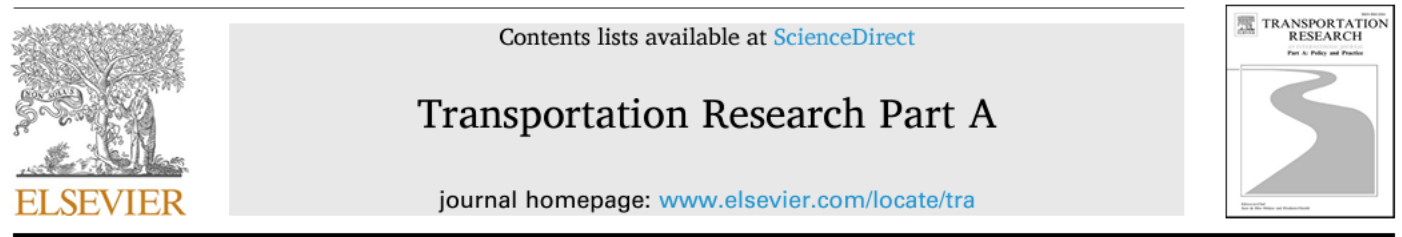
By Robert M. Terry at University of Richmond

Outline

- Paper sections (title, keywords, abstract, introduction, literature review, conclusions)
 - How to frame and write a paper?
 - Plagiarism
 - Tips
-
- Caveat: these may not be applicable to all fields and all papers.

An Effective Title

- Concise (more downloads)
- Informative – content, keywords, jargon, acronyms
- A writing hook



Ineffective built environment interventions: How to reduce driving in American suburbs?

Tao Tao^{*}, Jason Cao

Humphrey School of Public Affairs, University of Minnesota, USA

Title and keywords



Counterproductive development: New towns may produce and attract more long-distance commuting

Jiangbo Wang^a, Zhongyu Sun^b, Jason Cao^{c,*}, Kai Liu^a, De Wang^d

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- What are the keywords used for?
- Balance the needs between readers and (editors)

Abstract

- Why is it important? Editor, reviewer, reader
- Succinct: 100 words maximum (JPER)
- Components

An example

When and How Much Did the Green Line LRT Increase Single-Family Housing Values in St. Paul, Minnesota?

Xinyu (Jason) Cao¹ and Shengnan Lou¹

Abstract

Studies quantifying value added of transit often cannot differentiate whether the premiums are transit effects or location effects. Limited studies have examined the timing of value added. Using before and after data, this study explores the impact of the Green Line LRT on housing sales prices. Compared to the studied period before its funding announcement, its announcement increased housing values by \$9.2/sq ft and its commencement increased sales prices by \$13.7/sq ft. Further analyses show that housing value appreciation actually occurred after the announcement but before the commencement. Thus, using the right timing of value added is critical for value capture programs and benefit–cost analysis.

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An Example

- Studies quantifying value added of transit often cannot differentiate whether the premiums are transit effects or location effects. Limited studies have examined the timing of value added. **Using before and after data, this study explores the impact of the Green Line LRT on housing sales prices.** Compared to the studied period before its funding announcement, its announcement increased housing values by \$9.2/sq ft and its commencement increased sales prices by \$13.7/sq ft. Further analyses show that housing value appreciation actually occurred after the announcement but before the commencement. **Thus, using the right timing of value added is critical for value capture programs and benefit-cost analysis.**

Abstract – JPER workshop

- Why is it important? Editor, reviewer, reader
- Succinct: 100 words maximum (JPER)
- Components (JPER)
 - What is the issue addressed and why is it important for policy or practice? What gaps or misunderstandings in the literature does the research fill or correct?
 - How was the research conducted?
 - What are the research findings?
 - What are the conclusions for policy or practice and the implications for further research?

Introduction

- 3-4 paragraphs
- Address Terry's two questions in the first two paragraphs
 - Groundwork: "Is the groundwork adequately and clearly laid to guide readers into the topic that is being addressed?"
 - **Gaps/original contribution**: "Do they make the case that this is an important area for inquiry or examination?"
- Introduce the objective, method, and specific research questions, and end with the organization of your paper
- Statements vs. questions; free of jargon; discipline

1. Introduction

Traffic congestion in fast growing developing cities is notorious. Ranking fifth in China, the average travel time index of Wuhan was 1.945 during the third quarter of 2023.¹ That is, drivers needed to spend 19.45 min on a trip that would take 10 min without congestion. The rapid urbanization in developing countries have dwarfed the role of transit in their transportation systems and exacerbated traffic congestion. The restless expansion of human settlements to urban peripheries results in inferior transit accessibility in those areas and then makes cars more of a necessity (Yang et al., 2017). Therefore, car ownership has proliferated. For example, the number of registered vehicles in Brazil has increased by more than 80 % from 2005 to 2015; personal vehicles in China have grown to 242.9 million by 2020, a 430 % increase from 2009.² The staggering growth in car ownership and use further encroaches the transit market. Moreover, lack of transportation management resources and experience renders developing cities more vulnerable to traffic congestion (Bashingi et al., 2020).

S. Sun et al.

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Promoting transit in commuting mode choice is crucial for mitigating traffic congestion. Many developing countries have made massive investment on rapid transit and transit-oriented development to capture the lost market of conventional bus transit (Vergel-Tovar, 2022; Xu et al., 2017). The literature offers ample evidence for the effect of the built environment on transit use (Aston et al., 2021). However, transit allowance, a demand-side strategy used in developed countries for decades (Bhatt, 1991), has yet to be widely adopted in the developing world. Therefore, there is a limited understanding of how it, along with built environment interventions, can encourage transit use in developing countries.

To fill the gap, this study applies gradient boosting decision trees (GBDT) to data of a regional household travel survey in Wuhan. It aims to address the following research questions from the perspective of developing countries: (1) Which built environment interventions are promising to promote individuals' choice of transit for commuting? (2) How does transit allowance contribute to transit commuting? This study makes two significant contributions to the literature of transit use in developing countries. First, it identifies the most important built environment variables associated with transit commuting in a developing city, where transit use, as well as dense and mixed-use development, is more prevalent than developed cities. Although the relationships have been well studied in developed countries (Ewing and Cervero, 2010), the findings are not readily generalizable to developing countries. Therefore, this study sheds light on planning priorities specific to the developing world. Second, this study examines the effects of transportation allowance, both individually and in combination with built environment attributes, on transit commuting. This represents one of the initial efforts in literature.

Literature Review

- For whom are you writing?
- Why is it important?
 - To show your familiarity with the literature
 - To justify your “original” contributions to the field
- Components
 - Summarize what is known and what is not known
 - Discuss the gaps or controversies in previous studies
 - **Highlight the importance/consequences of these gaps**
 - Formulate questions and present how to address the gaps/controversies

Literature Review

- What papers should you cite?
 - Recent studies, classic papers
 - Target journals, top journals, potential reviewers
 - ...

Welcome to Find Reviewers. Please select one of the available search options below to identify potential reviewers.



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Literature Review

- What papers should you cite?
 - Recent studies, classic papers
 - Target journals, top journals, potential reviewers
 - ...
- Critique (vs. narrative)
 - It is highly recommended; to show your understanding
 - Highlight others' contribution and weaknesses (gaps)
- Theme

Conclusions

- KEY results: echo research questions in Introduction and gaps in Literature Review
- Policy implications
 - Based on results but beyond the results
- Limitations
 - Limitations + results vs. results + limitations
 - Limitations vs. recommendations

Framing and Writing

- Backward writing
- The first sentence is always the main point of the paragraph.
- What is a good logic?
 - Between paragraphs
 - Within paragraphs

Plagiarism - by Pat Mokhtarian

- “*Plagiarism* is the use of other people’s words or ideas without giving them appropriate credit.
- This commonly happens in one of two ways:
 - You present an idea that you obtained from another source, without citing that source.
 - You cite the source for your idea, but you use the source’s exact words without enclosing them in quotation marks.”
- <https://www.ieee.org/publications/rights/plagiarism/id-plagiarism.html>
 - “However, there are in fact degrees of plagiarism: one can steal an entire paper, or a section of a paper, or a page, a paragraph or a sentence. Even copying phrases without credit and quotation marks can be considered plagiarism. In other words, paraphrasing done improperly can qualify as plagiarism.”



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Exploring the connections among residential location, self-selection, and driving: Propensity score matching with multiple treatments

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Smart growth
Transportation
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Travel behavior

ABSTRACT

A large number of studies have investigated the association between the built environment and travel behavior. However, most studies did not explicitly quantify the contribution of residential self-selection to the connection. Using the 2006 data collected from a regional travel diary in Raleigh, NC, this study applies propensity score matching to explore the effects of the regional location of individuals' residences on their vehicle miles driven. **We found that residential location plays a more important role in affecting driving behavior than residential self-selection;** and that the self-selection effect is non-trivial when we compare driving behavior between urban residents and people living in other areas. Therefore, for such comparisons, the observed influence of residential locations on driving should be appropriately discounted when we evaluate the causal impacts of the built environment on travel behavior.

Citation Examples – Concerns?

- ... Residential location plays a more important role in affecting driving behavior than residential self-selection. ...
- ... Cao et al. (2010) concluded that residential location plays a more important role in affecting driving behavior than residential self-selection. ...
- ... Cao et al. (2010) concluded that “residential location plays a more important role in affecting driving behavior than residential self-selection”. ...
- ... Cao et al. (2010) concluded that residential self-selection plays a less important role in affecting driving behavior than residential location. ...
- ... Cao et al. (2010) concluded that the impact of residential location on driving behavior exceeds that of residential self-selection. ...

A few tips

- Read and cite recent and relevant papers published in the journal you intend to submit your paper.
- Highlight your unique contribution.
- Use simple words to write simple sentences.
- Editorial services: Do not irritate/frustrate reviewers with poor English.